

may be taken to link candidates' work in this section to historical models offered in **Section B** of **Unit G356: *Historical and Analytical Studies in Music***, e.g. song accompaniments of the early Romantic period, popular song.

Candidates are not required to generate pastiche compositions, creating all parts from an incipit. For exercises in most styles an incipit which is complete in all parts should be given. Thereafter, some kind of 'given part' should be present throughout each extract: this will normally be the principal melodic line, but some exercises might contain other given material such as harmonic landmarks or more harmonically advanced bars, for example, to form skeleton scores.

Extracts in all styles should be of sufficient length to allow candidates to demonstrate breadth of language and technique, and the suggested number of bars (16 to 24) may be taken as a loose guide. Shorter extracts at a slower tempo may, for example, require more intricate working than a longer extract at a faster tempo, where a similar harmonic underlay and a slower rate of harmonic change may be required.

The course of study must extend over a sufficient period of time to allow candidates to complete at least eight exercises.

Centre-supervised exercise

Towards the end of the course, candidates will be required to complete one of their exercises under centre supervision. The centre will select an appropriate stylistic exercise, which the candidate must not have seen previously and which should be typical of the work undertaken during the course. The candidate must be given 90 minutes to complete this exercise. Candidates can, if they wish, have access to any instrument of their choice to assist them. For candidates whose normal mode of working is using the computer, centres **must ensure** that the candidate has no access to any other software, programs or plug-ins that may assist the candidate in any way. The exercise should be assessed by the teacher, and must not be re-visited by the candidate. It should be included within the candidate's portfolio and clearly identified as the centre-supervised exercise.

Two-part vocal counterpoint of the late 16th century

Candidates are expected to develop their understanding of typical contrapuntal techniques of the late Renaissance. Examples for working may be drawn from Lassus, Palestrina, Byrd, Morley or any other appropriate sacred or secular source from the period. Techniques of melodic construction, counterpoint and vocal setting should be learned, including:

- the use of imitation; and
- rhythmic flow and variety.

Two-part Baroque keyboard counterpoint

Candidates are expected to develop their understanding of contrapuntal techniques in the Baroque period and their ability to recognise harmonic implications within a given melodic part. Extracts for working may be drawn from a wide range of repertoire, including not only equal-voice counterpoint, as found in Bach Inventions, for example, but also simpler 'melody and bass line' textures.

Candidates are expected to learn:

- harmonic awareness;
- melodic construction;
- treatment of vertical intervals and dissonance;
- use of imitation, sequence and common cadential patterns; and
- rhythmic flow and variety.

Chorale harmonisations in the style of J.S. Bach

Candidates are expected to develop their understanding of Bach's techniques of harmonising chorale melodies in four-part SATB form. Exercises for working usually consist of a complete melody to be harmonised from a complete incipit. In addition to being able to make appropriate harmonic selections, candidates are also expected to learn to construct a mobile and directional bass line, to address fluent and precise inner voice leading, and to treat cadences and modulations idiomatically.

String quartets in the Classical style

Candidates are expected to develop their ability to construct idiomatic quartet textures to support the 1st violin part from string quartets of the Classical period. In addition to appropriate chord selection through the identification of harmonic and non-harmonic notes within the melody, candidates also need to learn how to:

- construct a mobile and directional 'cello line;
- continue idiomatic accompaniment patterns across a harmonic progression; and
- handle cadences and modulations idiomatically;

and to:

- develop their understanding of appropriate quartet textures for the period; and
- extend the range of their harmonic vocabulary.

It is expected that the main melodic line will be given throughout in most extracts provided for candidates to work as exercises.

Keyboard accompaniments in early Romantic style

Candidates are expected to learn how to construct an idiomatic piano accompaniment to support a given vocal or instrumental part. In addition to understanding appropriate chord selection, and extending the range of their harmonic vocabulary, candidates are expected to learn how to:

- create idiomatic types of accompanimental figuration;
- maintain the consistency of figuration from a given incipit; and
- invent preludal/interludal/postludal passages to connect vocal phrases.

It is expected that the main melodic line will be given throughout in most extracts provided for candidates to work as exercises.

Popular song

Candidates are expected to learn how to construct an accompaniment for keyboard/piano/organ and/or appropriate instrumental group (maximum four instruments) to support a given vocal part as seen in the work of, for example, Gershwin, The Beatles, Tamla Motown performers or Led Zeppelin. In addition to understanding appropriate chord selection, and extending the range of their harmonic vocabulary, candidates are expected to learn how to:

- create and maintain idiomatic types of accompaniment figuration;
- give appropriate rhythmic support to the phrasing of the vocal line; and
- invent introductory, linking or concluding passages to connect and frame vocal phrases.

Serial technique

Candidates are expected to develop their understanding of serial techniques as seen in the work of the Second Viennese School, employing a minimum of two parts for any appropriate instrumentation. Candidates are expected to learn:

- the four basic versions of the row;
- melodic construction;
- treatment of vertical intervals and dissonance;
- the use of imitation; and
- rhythmic flow and variety.

Minimalism

Candidates are expected to develop their understanding of minimalist techniques as seen in the early work of the New York minimalists Riley, Glass and Reich, employing a minimum of three parts for any appropriate instrumentation. Candidates are expected to learn:

- use of ostinati and transformation;
- textural variety;
- melodic variety; and
- rhythmic flow and variety.

Section B: Composition

The principal focus of this section of the unit is the Area of Study **Interpretation**. In **Unit G354: Performing Music 2 (Interpretation)** candidates explore aspects of interpreting music in performance. **Section B of Unit G356: Historical and Analytical Studies in Music** offers opportunities for candidates to study how composers have interpreted texts, images and ideas at different times. Here, candidates are expected to express their own response to a stimulus, which may be text-based, visual (still or moving images), or simply a mood or character. They choose the stimulus and define their own brief for interpreting it in their composition.

An accompanying commentary should:

- define the brief clearly, setting out the candidate's intentions about interpreting the stimulus;
- document the compositional process (including explaining models that may have influenced it);
- appraise the effectiveness of the composition in carrying out the brief.

The choice of a musical language for the composition is at the discretion of the candidate but it should display a consistency appropriate to the style and/or genre. Candidates may choose, if they wish, to adopt a pastiche style, provided that it does **not** duplicate one offered in **Section A**, or to define their own stylistic language, drawing upon popular and non-Western styles where appropriate. The further study of **Tonality** in **Unit G356: Historical and Analytical Studies in Music** introduces candidates to an extensive range of 20th century approaches. This study may have some influence on their own choice of musical language for their composition.

Every opportunity should be given for candidates to develop their ability to hear what they compose. Whenever possible, they should hear their preparatory work performed, and learn to evaluate what they have composed, in discussion with other performers and/or audience.

1. Vocal composition

Candidates are expected to apply the understanding gained in their studies of vocal music in **Sections A and B of Unit G356: Historical and Analytical Studies in Music** to developing their own techniques for composing for voice. They need to understand the characteristic rhythms, sounds and intonation of the language of the chosen text (which need not be in English), the *rôle* of metre, stress and rhyme in word-setting, and to learn about techniques of vocal articulation and expression. In **Unit G356: Historical and Analytical Studies in Music**, candidates develop their understanding of how music can express the meaning of individual words, poetic ideas or dramatic situations. They are expected in this option to apply this understanding in interpreting a text. Candidates should be encouraged to explore a range of texts before deciding which one offers the best possibilities for them to demonstrate their command of compositional skills in interpreting it.

2. Programme music

Candidates who choose this option will find it helpful to study the Historical Topic: Programme Music in **Section B of Unit G356: Historical and Analytical Studies in Music**, where they may explore a range of techniques for interpreting extra-musical ideas in a piece of instrumental music without sung (or spoken) text. A stimulus may, in fact, be a text, and the instrumental composition closely tied to the interpretation of it; or the text may be treated more generally, characters and dramatic situations highlighted, a musical paraphrase; or a narrative may be no more than a legend. The expression of 'character' is, of course, possible without pre-existent text – there are

several well-known models (eg Schumann's *Carnaval*, Elgar's *Enigma Variations*). Visual stimuli also offer potential for interpretation. Candidates who wish to take simply a 'mood' as their stimulus will need to be explicit about its nature in their brief.

All candidates should be encouraged to develop their ideas about a possible stimulus in discussion before making a decision, and should be advised to explain the process of choosing in their brief.

3. Film/TV composition

Candidates are expected to develop their compositional imagination and technique in creating appropriate interpretative backgrounds, their imagination in the use of their chosen performance medium, their ability to meet the limitations of given timings and the ability to control the overall structure of their composition around those timings.

Candidates are required to compose music for a storyboard, DVD clip, TV title theme, cartoon or advertisement. The stimulus is to be chosen by the candidate from any suitable source and the total duration should not exceed **four** minutes.

Whichever option is chosen, the assignment may be composed for any medium:

- purely acoustic;
- amplified;
- a combination of purely acoustic and amplified; or
- electro-acoustic instruments.

Candidates **must not** duplicate the compositional style of their other option from **Section A, Unit G355: Composing 2**.

A copy of the text/stimulus in a form appropriate to it, together with a recording of the completed assignment, either in its intended instrumentation or reduced as a piano or synthesized/sequenced demonstration, must be submitted.

The recording must be accompanied by **either**:

a full score in a form appropriate to the style, which serves as the principal examination document;

or:

a full commentary on the methods of mixing and producing the master recording, which becomes the principal examination document to be assessed on production values. If this option is taken, the master is assessed on the use of appropriate sound levels, balance between parts, effective stereo image, appropriate equalisation, reverberation or other effect, and use of a full frequency spectrum.

3.6 A2 Unit G356: *Historical and Analytical Studies in Music*

Assessment

Candidates are required to sit an externally-assessed timed examination paper of 1 hour 45 minutes (plus 15 minutes preparation time). The paper is in two sections. Candidates are provided with individual CD recordings containing **one** extract of music for Section A, which they may play as many times as they wish, together with a printed insert containing the score of the extract.

Questions in both sections of the paper draw on prescribed repertoire relevant to the two Areas of Study: **Tonality** and **Interpretation**.